

A HIPPO CAN
**OPEN ITS
ENORMOUS
MOUTH UP TO
AN ANGLE OF**

120

**DEGREES—
WIDER THAN
ANY OTHER
LARGE
MAMMAL**

**ADULT MALE
COMMON
HIPPOS CAN
WEIGH UP TO
4,400 LB
(2,000 KG)**



Fertile lakes

Dung produced by hundreds of pooping hippos helps enrich lakes, fertilizing the water with nutrients that can support food chains with big shoals of fishes.

Lake Victoria

Lake Tanganyika

Congo

Okavango Delta

Coastal hippos

The coast of the Namib Desert is the only place where hippos can be seen cooling off in shallow seawater.

Namib Desert

Nocturnal grazer

The common hippo gets most of its food on land. It grazes on grass at night, using its fleshy lips to pluck the blades.

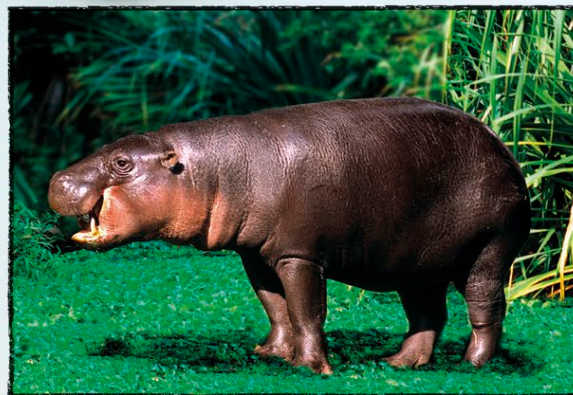
Hippo havens

The common hippopotamus, the larger of the two species, lives in patches of woodland and grassland around rivers across sub-Saharan Africa. The pygmy hippopotamus only survives in a few fragments of rainforest in West Africa.

**HIPPOS CAN
HOLD THEIR
BREATH FOR**



**MINUTES
SUBMERGED
IN WATER**



Mini hippo

The forest-dwelling pygmy hippopotamus is about half as tall as its bigger cousin. Shaded by over-hanging trees, it probably spends more time out of water during the day than the common hippo, but its habits are little known.